



3.0 Reading Comprehension

Pet Store

Materials

- Poster board
- Stuffed animals/Pet pictures
- **LBRY50**

Objectives

- L1 - L3** The student will listen attentively to the story.
- L1 - L3** The student will respond to simple questions about the reading material.
- L1 - L3** The student will identify the different pet types.
- L2 - L3** The student will use descriptive words to describe pets.

Activity

Teacher Preparation: Prior to the activity, the teacher should create a “Pet Shop Window” using poster board and any other materials available to decorate and design the window.

1. The teacher will begin the lesson by reading (**LBRY50**).
2. The teacher will ask the class simple questions about the story, developing reading comprehension and retention of pertinent information.
3. Next, the teacher will hold the “window” in front of various animals and ask what kind of pet it is.
4. Students should be encouraged to give a description and pretend to know how much the pet costs.
5. To close the lesson, sing the song “How much is the doggy in the window.”

How much is that doggy in the window?

How much is that doggy in the window? (bark)
The one with the wiggly tail.
How much is that doggy in the window? (bark)
I do hope that doggy is for sale!

How much is that kitty in the window? (meow)
The one that purrs so
How much is that kitty in the window? (meow)
I do hope that kitty is for sale!

How much is that bunny in the window? (hop)
The one that goes hip-ity-hop
How much is that bunny in the window? (hop)
I do hope that bunny is for sale!



- Teacher observation of student’s ability to listen and respond with some relevancy during the discussion.
- Teacher observation of student’s ability to describe and determine cost.



3.1 Alphabet Recognition and Sounds

My Pet Collage

Materials

- ☐ Glue
- ☐ Large wall alphabet
- ☐ Pet store catalogs
- ☐ Picture of their own pet brought from home
- ☐ Scissors
- ☐ White cardstock

Objectives

- L1** The student will be able to sing the alphabet song.
- L1** The student will follow simple steps to accomplish a task.
- L2 - L3** The student will recognize some beginning sounds.

Activity

Teacher Preparation: Prior to the activity the teacher will need to send a note home with students asking for students to come in with a picture of their pet. The teacher will have dog and cat cut outs for the students to choose from in case they do not have a pet at home or forgot their picture.

1. The teacher will begin the lesson by having the students sing the “ABC song.”
2. Following the song, the teacher will talk about the types of pets that may be found at home.
3. The teacher will point at different alphabet letters and state the pet-themed words and strongly state beginning letter sound that begin with the letter. Students repeat the sound and the word. L2 - L3 Students will guess at which pet name begins with the letter the teacher is pointing at.
4. Next, the students will be guided to create a Pet collage. In the center, the students will glue their pet picture brought from home or a dog/cat picture chosen from the teacher’s selection.
5. Using pet catalogs from local pet stores or images from the internet, have the students cut out pet-related items that match to their pet.
6. Guide as necessary.



- Teacher observation of student’s ability to listen to a story and respond accordingly.
- Teacher observation of student’s ability to recognize some beginning sounds.
- Teacher observation of student’s individual fine motor skills and their choices of pictures for the collage.

3.2

Alphabet Recognition and Sounds

Story Telling

Materials

- Coloring pencils
- Markers
- White cardstock
- **LBRY29**

Objectives

- L1 - L3** The student will listen attentively.
- L1 - L3** The student will apply their favorite part of the story to complete the task at hand.
- L2 - L3** The student will be able to discuss the story using complete sentences.

Activity

1. The teacher will begin the lesson by reading (**LBRY29**).
2. After the story, the teacher will ask simple questions to exercise story sequencing, comprehension and retention of important information.
3. The students will be instructed to draw their favorite part of the story.
4. The teacher will be a constant guide as she/he encourages the use of many colors, pretend spelling and the use of creativity.
5. When the students have all finished their drawings, one by one they will share with their classmates what their favorite part of the story was and how they interpreted that onto their drawing.



- Teacher observation of student's ability to listen attentively, discuss details from the story, draw and color their favorite part of the story and share drawing by articulating age appropriately.



3.3

Cognitive Development

Pet Collars

Materials

- ❑ Crayons / markers and collar decorations as desired
- ❑ Strips of tag board (for collars) and stapler
- ❑ Students will bring in a stuffed "pet" animal

Objectives

L1 - L3

The student will use fine motor skills to create a puppy collar.

L2 - L3

The student will create their own pet collars using memory and imagination.

Activity

1. The teacher will begin the lesson by asking the students to raise their hand if they have a pet.
2. The teacher will ask questions (e.g., Why do we need to keep our pets under control? How do we keep our pets under control? Does your pet have a collar?)
3. After the discussion, the students will color and decorate their own pet collars.
4. The teacher will encourage them to write their pet's name on the collar.
5. The teacher will staple the collar into a circle.
6. The teacher will guide and help as needed.
7. Finally, the students will put their collar on their stuffed animal pet.



- Teacher observation of student's ability to recall details and talk about why pets need collars.



3.4

Prediction and Auditory Memory

Reading Pictures

Materials

□ LBRY46

Objectives

- L1 - L3 The student will use their auditory memory to predict what will happen next in the story.
- L1 - L3 The student will analyze and judge each character, as evidenced by their critical thinking and oral responses.

Activity

1. The teacher will gather the class around for a story with a twist.
2. The teacher will present (**LBRY46**) and encourage the students to predict what will happen next by looking at the pictures. The teacher will present the pages but not read aloud.
3. Following the story, the teacher will discuss the story with the class.
 1. **L1** - **L3** Students will tell which part of the story they liked the best and the least.
 2. **L2** - **L3** Students will clearly state why.
 3. **L1** - **L3** Students will tell which character in the story they liked the best and the least, and **L2** - **L3** students will explain why.



- Teacher observation of student's who can picture read and who has the oral language and auditory memory to predict what will happen next.
- The teacher will rate student responses based on the depth of their reasoning. For example, a response: "because I liked her dress" would rate low, a response such as "because she is a good dancer just like me and my" would rate higher.



3.5

Concept of Print – Directionality

Left to Right, That's How We Read!

Materials

- Easel
- Large print book (preferably theme-related)
- Pointer stick

Objectives

- L1 The student will experience the left to right directionality of reading.
- L2 - L3 The student will discover and experience the left to right directionality of reading.

Activity

L1 Activity

The teacher will read aloud a large print book while using a pointer, pointing to the words as they are read aloud. The teacher will read from left to right and top to bottom of the page

L2 - L3 Activity

1. The teacher will read aloud a large print book.
2. Students will take turns holding the pointer and moving the pointer to the words as the teacher reads.



- Teacher observation of student's reading readiness skills (how students are able to hold a book correctly, turn pages appropriately, determine the front from the back, "read" the pictures and enjoy the process of reading readiness and the use of directionality).
- The teacher will assist or model the appropriate skills for students not practicing at the appropriate skill level.

3.6

Letter Recognition and Sounds

Buried Letters!

Materials

- Plastic letters (upper and lower case)
- Sand table or trays

Objectives

L1 - L3

The student will recognize the first letter of their name.

L2 - L3

The student will recognize the letters of the alphabet in, upper and lower case.

Activity

L1 Activity

Students will dig until they find the beginning letter of their name.

L2 - L3 Activity

1. Students will dig for buried letters (upper and lower case)
2. As the students find letters, they should identify the letter. The letters that they identified those they identify correctly should be placed to the side for counting (have a contest to see who knows the most letters).
3. After the students have finished their turn, rebury all the letters.



- Teacher observation of student's eagerness to participate and their individual letter recognition skills.

3.7

Rhyming Five Little Kittens

Materials

Objectives

L1 - L3

The student will actively participate in a rhyming activity.

L2 - L3

The student will identify rhyming words.

Activity

1. The teacher will begin the lesson by reading the poem below.
2. The teacher should explain rhyming (hat, cat, mat, rat/house, mouse).
3. The teacher will read the poem again, stating the rhyming words for **L1** students.
L2 - **L3** Students should call out the rhyming words.
4. The teacher will read the poem one last time, but this time, he/she should incorporate actions to the poem and encourage all the students to join in.

Five Kittens in a Row

Five little kittens standing in a row,
They nod their heads to the children, like so.
They run to the left, they run to the right,
They stand up and stretch in the bright sunlight.
Along comes a dog who's in for some fun,
Meow, see those kittens run.



- Teacher observation of student's active participation in the activity.



3.8

Reading Readiness

I Love Books!

Materials

□ Books

Objectives

- L1** The student will enjoy “reading” books with classmates.
- L2** The student will enjoy reading books and telling a classmate about the book.
- L3** The student will enjoy reading books and will “read” to a small group of students.

Activity

The teacher will remind students about directionality – the left to right and the top to bottom of the page of reading.

- L1 Students will select books and enjoy reading them with a classmate.
- L2 Students will read a book and select a classmate to share a book with.
- L3 Students will read a book and “read” it with a small group.



- Teacher observation of the student’s participation and eagerness in reading books. The teacher will encourage those who may not be enjoying (reading and looking at) a book.



4.0

Pet Awareness Paper Plate Pets

Materials

- ☐ Glue
- ☐ Hole punch
- ☐ Preprinted images of household pets (e.g. dog, cat, hamster, parrot, rabbit, etc)
- ☐ Scissors
- ☐ White paper plates
- ☐ Yarn
- ☐ **LBRY47**

Objectives

- L1 - L3** The student will demonstrate caring for a pet.
- L1 - L3** The student will listen attentively to the story.
- L1 - L3** The student will role-play with friends by playing "Pets" and showing respect and good care habits.

Activity

1. The teacher will begin the lesson by reading (**LBRY47**).
2. The teacher will guide a discussion asking simple questions about the story and the proper ways of taking care of a pet.
3. Have the students discuss their own experience with pets. How do they contribute to the care of their pets?
4. Next, the students will each choose from (**PET-S3**) to color and cut out.
5. After the student has finished coloring and cutting, the teacher will assist as needed with gluing the picture onto the paper plate.
6. The teacher will then punch holes on both sides of the plate. The teacher will take and tie yarn to the paper plate pets. Some students will wear these paper plate pets while playing in the dramatic play area. The non-pets will demonstrate how to love and care for pets.



- Teacher observation of student's ability to listen and apply story information to their own experience with pets.
- Teacher observation of student's ability to discuss and role-play the appropriate care needed in order to have healthy and happy pets.

Which Pet Would You Choose?



4.1

Personal Choices Choosing a Pet

Materials

- Assorted colors of clay
- Clay/Cookie cutter shapes

Objectives

L2 - L3

The student will use fine motor skills to mold out of clay their interpretation of the perfect pet.

L1 - L3

The student will use age-appropriate language to show and talk about their clay creation.

Activity

1. The teacher will begin the lesson by asking each student what their perfect pet would be if they had a choice and what effect their choice of a pet would have on their family.
2. Following the discussion, the students will work on their interpretation of their perfect pet by using clay. The teacher will encourage students to use tools, different colored clay, etc.
3. After, all the students have finished their pets, have each student come up in front of the class and discuss their perfect pet creation.



- Teacher observation of student's active and relevant responses to the effects choices have.

An illustration at the top of the page shows two children and an elephant in a snowy, winter-like setting. On the left, a girl with brown hair wearing a pink coat and purple pants is gesturing towards the elephant. In the center, a boy with blonde hair wearing a green coat and brown boots is standing. On the right, a large grey elephant with white spots on its body is looking towards the children. A small blue bird is on the ground to the right of the elephant. The background is a light blue sky with white snowflakes and a brown ground with some scattered fruit like bananas and apples.

4.2 Consequences

Unusual Pet Choices

Materials

- Crayons/Colored pencils/Markers
- A4/US Letter size copy paper
- **PET-C11**

Objectives

- L1** The student will develop awareness that some animals are not good pet choices.
- L2 - L3** The student will evaluate different choices of pets.

Activity

1. The teacher will begin the lesson by reviewing previous lessons on pets, discussing what animals are common pets.
2. The teacher will introduce the concept of “unusual” pets.
3. The teacher should encourage students to try and name some “unusual” pets. Using **(PET-C11)**, the teacher can show students what some people call their pets.
4. The teacher and students will discuss why some pets are better than others (endangered species, messy, aggressive, etc).
5. After the discussion, each student should draw and color an animal they feel would make for an unusual pet.
6. After the students have finished their drawing, have them attempt at writing the name of the animal on the back (teacher assistance may be needed).
7. Once all the students have completed their drawings, have each student come up in front of the class and discuss their drawing.



- Teacher observation of student’s ability to name household pets, use fine motor skills to color and use pretend spelling.



5.0

Gross Motor Development

Indoor Outdoor Fun!

Materials

- ☐ Balls
- ☐ Beanbags
- ☐ Frisbees
- ☐ Hula-hoops
- ☐ Jump rope
- ☐ Old pillow cases
- ☐ Open space
- ☐ Ride-on toys
- ☐ Tricycles

Objectives

- L1 - L3** The student will follow simple safety rules when performing gross motor activities.
- L1 - L3** The student will demonstrate increased physical competency by participating in various physical activities.
- L1 - L3** The student will begin demonstrating an understanding and awareness that physical activity is necessary for a healthy and balanced life.
- L1 - L3** The student will demonstrate increased endurance by participating in physical activities that will build muscle strength, coordination and flexibility.

Activity

The teacher should provide enough time during play time to observe and guide students to perform activities (e.g., walk in a straight line, walk backwards, run, march, stand on one foot, hop, jump forward, jump backwards, climb stairs, alternate feet walking down the stairs, slide, throw, catch, bounce and kick a ball). Some students at this age may also be able to skip or pedal a tricycle. The teacher should provide opportunity for the development of such skills.

The teacher should provide enough opportunities weekly for free play outdoors (for activities like taking walks, running, riding bikes or scooters and play with frisbees, hula-hoops, jump ropes or balls).

Bean Bag Activity

The students will each be given a beanbag. The teacher will show the students the start and finish line. The students will race while balancing a bean bag on their head to the finish line.

Another beanbag activity is to take turns tossing beanbags into buckets from various distances.

Jump Rope Activity

The teacher will wiggle a jump rope along the ground like a snake as each student takes a turn to jump over it.

Favorites Activity

The teacher will use two old pillowcases having two students at a time each step into a pillowcase. The students will race from point A to point B.

Two students at a time will race each other while running/walking fast from point A to point B while holding a potato/toy in a spoon.



- Teacher observation of student's ability to safely participate in all physical activities that increase mastery and endurance.



5.1

Directions and Actions

Obstacle Course

Materials

- ☐ Ball
- ☐ Chair
- ☐ Cones
- ☐ Jump rope
- ☐ Large bean bags
- ☐ Stop watch

Objectives

L1 - L3

The students will use observation skills and memory, and maneuver their bodies as required.

Activity

Teacher Preparation: Prior to the activity, the teacher will set up a simple obstacle course in an open area (e.g., jump over a rope, toss a beanbag into a bucket, do five jumping jacks, kick a ball into the goal, crawl under a table, then zig zag through the cones to the finish line). For **L2** - **L3** make this into a contest, use a stop watch to time students and determine who is the fastest.

Non-Stop Watch Activity

1. The teacher will take the students slowly through the obstacle course, explaining each action required.
2. After the demonstration is complete, have the students begin taking turns (to assist in the waiting time, after the first student is at the third station, have the next student begin the course).
3. Repeat as interest holds.

Stop Watch Activity

1. The teacher will take the students slowly through the obstacle course, explaining each required action.
2. After the demonstration is complete, have the students begin taking turns.
3. After each student finished the teacher will write the name of the student and the time they completed the course.
4. After all students have gone through the course, the teacher should gather the students in a circle and go over the times for each student and announce the fastest student.



- Teacher observation of the student's ability to maneuver through the obstacle course, noting the correctness of their physical actions.



5.2

Listening The Trainer says...

Materials

- Open space

Objectives

L1 - L3

The student will listen and perform physical body movements as per a command.

Activity

Play the game *Simon Says*, though instead of saying “Simon says,” say “The Trainer Says.”

Example:

The Trainer says sit down.

The Trainer says spin around.

The Trainer says jump.

The Trainer says bark like a dog.

The Trainer says meow like a cat.

The Trainer says touch your nose.



- Teacher observation of student's playfully participate and follow commands.



5.3

Balancing Skills

If the Cat in the Hat can Balance That, Then so Can I!

Materials

- Items for balancing
(e.g., book, marker, blocks, paper)
- **LBRY48**

Objectives

- L1** - **L3** The student will demonstrate a sense of balance.

Activity

1. The teacher will begin the lesson by reading (**LBRY48**).
2. The teacher will demonstrate balancing one item at a time on their head.
3. The students will then try to balance different items themselves.



- Teacher observation of student's balancing attempts.

Living



Non-Living



6.0

Classification

Animal, Pet or Non-Living

Materials

- PET-C6
- IPC-C13

Objectives

- L1 The student will collect and describe information.
- L2 - L3 The student will develop awareness that animals are living things.
- L2 - L3 The student will be able to classify animals and non-living objects.

Activity

1. The teacher will begin the lesson by discussing the difference between living and non-living.
2. The teacher will guide a discussion on focusing on what living things need to survive (e.g., food, water, shelter, sleep).
3. The students will work in small groups using **(IPC-C13)** and **(PET-C6)**, sorting through flash cards. Students will classify animals and non-living objects (L2 - L3 students will sort into 3 groups, including pets).



- Teacher observation of student's participation during the class discussion and the ability to classify animals from non-living objects (L2 - L3 including pets).



6.1

Scientific Observation

Baby Animals and Their Parents

Materials

- Baby animals and their corresponding parent made into flashcards
- Glue
- Popsicle sticks
- **LBRY49**

Objectives

- L1** The student will listen attentively to the story.
- L2 - L3** The student will actively play matching game.

Activity

1. The teacher will begin the lesson by reading **(LBRY49)**.
2. As a class, discuss the story.
3. After story and discussion, the teacher will group students in pairs to play matching game using flashcards that show the baby animal and the parent animal separately. The students must work collaboratively to match and group the baby animals to their parents.
4. **L2** – **L3** Make this a memory matching game: place all of the flash cards face side down, and have the students match the pairs by letting them turn over two cards at a time. If the match is correct they remove the cards, but if not the cards are replaced in their same location, and it is the next persons turn.
5. Optional: project
6. Next, the student will choose two corresponding animals, such as a kitten and a cat, to color, cut and glue on Popsicle sticks to make animal puppets.



- Teacher observation of student's ability to match corresponding animals and work together for a common goal.



6.2

Cognitive Thought

Pet Home Match

Material

- PET-C12
- PET-S4

Objectives

L1

The student will match pets to their homes.

L2

- L3

The student will design pet homes.

Activity

1. The teacher will begin the lesson by gathering the class for a group discussion about pet homes, asking students where they think various pets live (e.g., where does a bunny live?...a dog, etc).
- 2.
3. **L1** Students will match the pet to its home.
4. **L2** – **L3** Students will select various pets and draw their appropriate home.
5. The teacher will perform group and individual discussions during the process.



- Teacher observation of student's ease in which the pet to home activity is accomplished.



6.3

Sense Discovery

Pet Food Investigation

Materials

- Pet food (various types)
- Sandwich baggies

Objectives

L1 - L3

The student will examine various pet foods and identify what pet eats which food.

Activity

Teacher Preparation: Prior to the activity, the teacher will need to get various types of pet food (bird, fish, dog, cat, rabbit) and then place them in the sandwich bags for students to examine.

1. The teacher will begin the lesson by proposing the questions to the class, “What do you think pets eat?”
2. The teacher will then pull out the bags of food and pass around to the class.
3. Students will take turns looking at and feeling each bag of food.
4. After all the students have had a chance to examine the different types of pet food, the teacher should talk about what kind of pet would eat each type of food and how the pet eats (focus on their teeth and mouth).



- Teacher observation of student's active participation during the discussion and investigation.



7.0

Choral Singing

Old MacDonald Had a...

Materials

Objectives

L1 - L3 The student will participate in choral singing.

Activity

The song below is an adapted version of Old Mac Donald. This song can be added in addition to any of the lessons within the Pets Thematic Unit.

OLD MAC DONALD

Tune: "Old MacDonald Had A Farm"

Old MacDonald had a farm, EIEIO.

And on this farm he had a pet, EIEIO.

With a meow, meow, here, and a meow, meow there,

Here a meow, there a meow,

Old MacDonald had a pet, EIEIO.

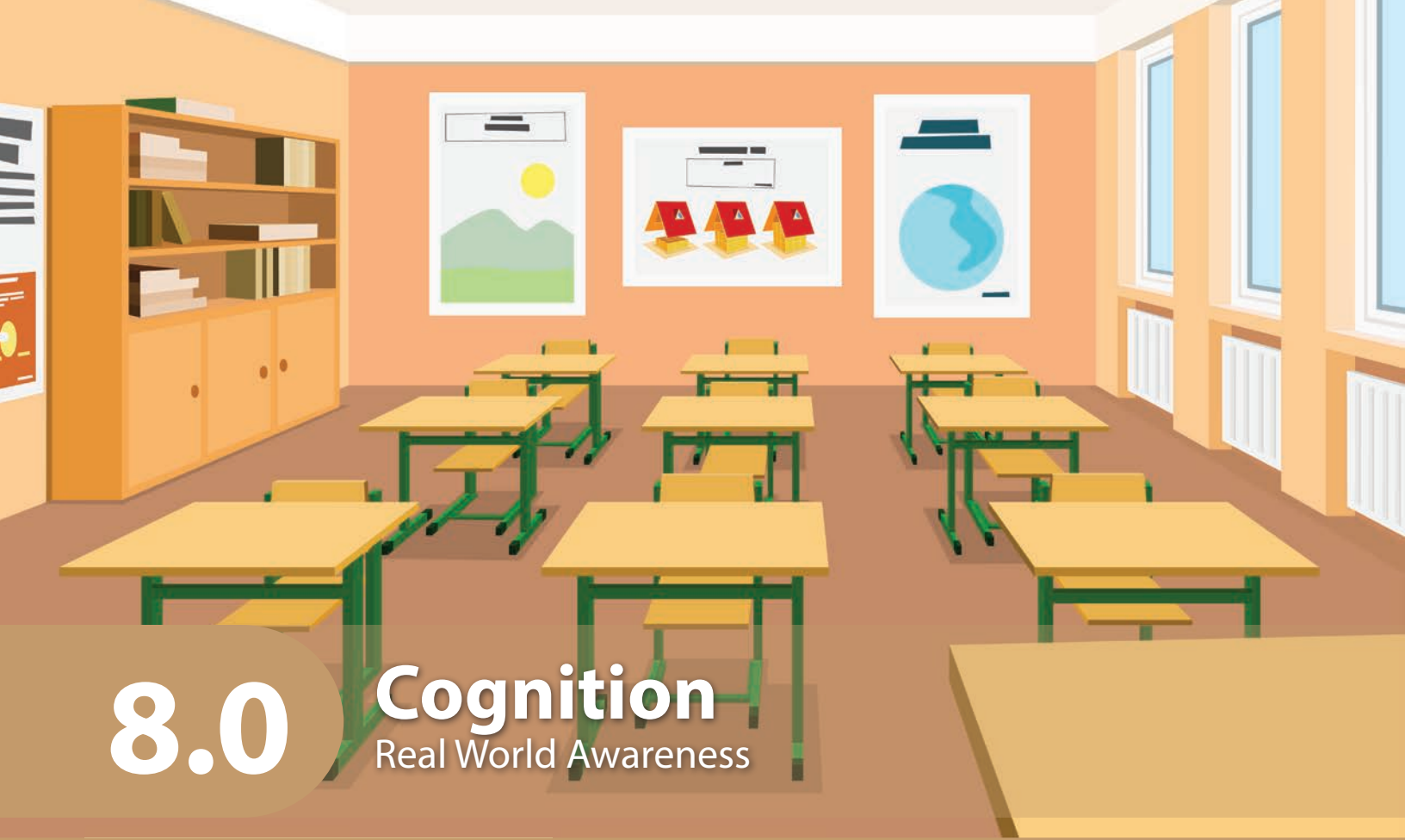
Adapted Traditional

Can you guess what kind of pet Old MacDonald had?

Continue with other pets that Old MacDonald may have had.



- Teacher observation of students who participate actively. The teacher will encourage all to join in



8.0

Cognition

Real World Awareness

Materials

- List of questions

Objectives

- L1** The student will use their past experiences to respond to real world questions.
- L1 - L3** The student will expand their imagination and sense of reality in their responses.

Activity

Teacher Preparation: Prior to the activity, the teacher will need to prepare a list of questions for the class.

1. The teacher begin the lesson by gathering the students.
2. The teacher will ask the class questions from his/hers prepared list.

Sample Questions:

- ☐ What would it be like to be a pet dog? Bird? Cat?
- ☐ What would you do if your pet ran away?
- ☐ Why do people have pets?
- ☐ I wonder why pet dogs / cats are not purple in color?
- ☐ I wonder
- ☐ Why...?
- ☐ What would you do...?



- The teacher will listen students' responses to the questions to determine who has a good connection of real events that happen in their daily lives and their level of imagination.

Classroom Sing Along

9.0

Choral Language Development

Sing Along Songs..

Materials

□ PET-C13

Objectives

L1 - L3

The students will actively participate, experience and develop language.

Activity

The song below along with (PET-C13) can be added in addition to any of the lessons within the Pets Thematic Unit.

Love Your Pets

Sung to: "Row, Row, Row Your Boat"

Love, love

Love your pets,

Love them

Every day.

Give them food

And water, too,

Then let them

Run and play.



- Teacher observation of student's active participation in the choral singing. The teacher will encourage all to join in and sing.

Additional books to further the curriculum

My Visit to the Aquarium. Aliko. New York: HarperCollinsPublishers, 1993. Print.

Whose Baby Am I? Butler, John. New York: Viking, 2001. Print.

Are You My Mother? Eastman, P. D. [New York]: Beginner ; Distributed by Random House, 1960. Print.

If You Give a Cat a Cupcake. Numeroff, Laura Joffe., and Felicia Bond. [New York]: Laura Geringer, 2008. Print.

The Perfect Pet. Palatini, Margie, and Bruce Whatley. New York: HarperCollins, 2003. Print.

My Big Animal Book. Priddy, Roger. New York, NY: St. Martin's by Priddy Bicknell, 2002. Print.

The Great Gracie Chase: Stop That Dog. Rylant, Cynthia, and Mark Teague. New York: Blue Sky, 2001. Print.

W Is for Woof: A Dog Alphabet. Strother, Ruth, and Gijsbert Van Frankenhuyzen. Chelsea, MI: Sleeping Bear, 2008. Print.

How Much Is That Doggie in the Window? Trapani, Iza, and Bob Merrill. Boston: Whispering Coyote, 1997. Print.

**Additional books do not come included and are not necessary to purchase.*



